Figma Board

Color key:

1. Blue: Interviews (# in parentheses represents which interview)
2. Pink: Observations
3. Green: Diary Studies
4. Purple: Surveys

GPA calculation confusion and missing information

- Many people can not calculate their GPA because the information is either missing or hard to find. — Layla
- Many people do not really understand how credit works and also can't find any rules of calculating GPA which are appropriate for them. — Layla
- Some people are confused about what classes are weighted/ unweighted, whether AP or Honors (11) — Zoey Zhang
- Some people have issues with the math required to calculate different types of GPAs (9) — Zoey Zhang
- Not sure whether Aeries takes into account + or -, which is important for AP classes — Shogo Muranaka
- Hard to know what calculation colleges will use compared to the ones shown in Aeries. — Shogo Muranaka
- Middle GPA is included into overall, leading to confusion — Shogo Muranaka
- Finding high school GPA from Aeries is difficult b/c the total includes middle school, and the single only includes that semester (14) — Zoey Zhang
- People are unsure how the GPA affects their final 4 year grade (12) — Zoey Zhang
- Using only Aeries info/ tools, its difficult to find your GPA from different semesters sometimes; requires external help (e.g calculator) (10) — Zoey Zhang
- Aeries, when summarizing all grades, includes middle school -- this is troublesome for seeing overall GPA (6) — Zoey Zhang
- Colleges handle GPAs very differently, Aeries doesn't mention them all (2) — Zoey Zhang

Factors considered when choosing classes

- 80.8% — Career interest — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 21.2% — School counselor recommendations — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 46.2% — Homework load/Difficulty level — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 59.6% — Peer opinions — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 75% — College entry requirements — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 73.1% — High school graduation requirements — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka
- 61.5% — Parent Opinion — (What do you consider before choosing classes? Please select all applicable options.) — Shogo Muranaka

Navigation and usability issues

- Hard to navigate (1) — Zoey Zhang
- Not user intuitive (1) — Zoey Zhang
- Has a lot of sub pages with poor navigation — Shogo Muranaka
- The Aeries app has too much different parts on the first page, overwhelming (5) — Zoey Zhang
- Most people know their GPA or credits exists, but they have to click everywhere to find it. — Layla
- Difficult to access places to calculate/estimate possible grades and GPAs (5) — Zoey Zhang
- Logging in repeatedly can take a long time, some people would prefer an option to save the login info (9) — Zoey Zhang
- Some complaints include confusion in organization. — Zoey Zhang
- Some complaints include slowness when loading. — Zoey Zhang

Grade tracking and prediction needs

Many people would like to see future grade possibilities, like what score you need to get on an assignment to get a desired grade (8)

Zoey Zhang

Some people calculate the worst score they can get to maintain an A (19)

Zoey Zhang

Many people are manually playing with numbers to see how to hit a goal because the app doesn't do it for them.

Layla

Accounting for grades that haven't been added.

Shogo Muranaka

People also tend to focus on current assignments, because those grades are rapidly changing (11)

Zoey Zhang

People change looking at their current semester grade and overall grade depending on their goals (15)

Zoey Zhang

Students who want to track things the app does not support, like out of state college requirements or personal credit goals.

Layla

Frequency of checking grades and credits

19.2%

Rarely

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

7.7%

Multiple times a week

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

17.3%

Only before tests

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

51.9%

Only before midterms/ finals

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

3.8%

Never

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

Some people only check their GPA before course selection or major tests (16)

Zoey Zhang

Most people spend under 5 minutes on Aeries, with a maximum of ~15 minutes.

Zoey Zhang

Weighted vs unweighted GPA visibility

weighted/unweighted GPA does not show in homescreen

Shogo Muranaka

Some people wish that weighted classes/ unweighted classes had a symbol next to the class on the homepage to make GPA easier to calculate (17)

Zoey Zhang

Have to put in different % amounts for different categories of classes

Shogo Muranaka

Can't properly measure weight and some classes

Shogo Muranaka

Primary reasons for tracking GPA

44.2%

College requirements/ recommendations

(What is the primary reason you track your GPA?)

Shogo Muranaka

40.4%

Personal goals/Parental goals

(What is the primary reason you track your GPA?)

Shogo Muranaka

1.9%

High school graduation requirements

(What is the primary reason you track your GPA?)

Shogo Muranaka

13.5%

I do not track my GPA

(What is the primary reason you track your GPA?)

Shogo Muranaka

How students track academic credits

1.9%

I record it physically (notebook, paper)

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

9.6%

I do not keep track of my academic credits

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

11.5%

I record it digitally (Google Docs)

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

76.9%

I check Aeries for my credit

(Where do you keep track of your current academic credits?)

Shogo Muranaka

Teacher grading delays and data accuracy

Teachers are very late in inputting assignment/test grades.

Shogo Muranaka

There's a lot of delay when teachers grade assignments, so it's difficult to see your 'real' grade (10)

Zoey Zhang

The Aeries app is very buggy, and has a slow updating rate (19)

Zoey Zhang

Some complaints include teacher delays when grading.

Zoey Zhang

Confusing terminology and codes

Some people are confused by the weird codes like QTR, PRG, or I/E and have to leave the app to google what they mean.

Layla

The categories are vague and the names don't make sense for what they do (10)

Zoey Zhang

External tools and workarounds

Some people use AI to calculate their GPAs (9)

Zoey Zhang

People estimate their GPA mentally, instead of using a calculator app sometimes (11)

Zoey Zhang

Overwhelmingly, people do not go outside of Aeries to check for grades.

Zoey Zhang

User behavior and focus patterns

Most people focus on their current semester, because they can still change that grade (6)

Zoey Zhang

Some people check for the worst possible score they can aim for but go for the best (2)

Zoey Zhang

During testing, more students go to the Student Info page for their SSIDs.

Zoey Zhang

Overwhelmingly, people look at the Gradebook.

Zoey Zhang

The home page is what most people look at, with some glancing at the grades that show up there and leaving without clicking on anything else.

Zoey Zhang